

From: [Hughes](#)
To: [Secretary](#)
Subject: Docket No. 20-15, Comments on PVO Financial Responsibility Rulemaking
Date: Friday, October 29, 2021 7:37:23 PM

Greetings

I would like to add my comments to the proposed rule requiring cruise lines to refund passenger fare when the ship is cancelled or boarding is delayed.

1. The rules should be firm that refunds shall be made to the passengers original payment. Even when the passenger paid with the cancelled cruise with funds brought forward from a previous booking, the refund should trace back to the form in which the passenger initially transferred the money into the hands of the cruise line.
2. It is really outrageous to expect passengers to wait up to 180 days for refunds if the cruise is cancelled due to government direction (ie cruise shutdown during 2020 Covid epidemic). Even though cruising is a vacation choice, people may still have need of that money themselves due to financial crisis caused by the very same situation that led to the government cruise cancellation. During 2020, millions of Americans were in such financial distress that the government handed out trillions of dollars in relief to keep people and businesses afloat. Some of those people could have made use of the money from cancelled vacation plans. Leaving the refund at cruise line discretion to hold the money for 180 day is a subsidy to the industry at individual taxpayer and citizen costs since it's directly out of the pockets of individuals rather than the collective taxes or debts of the federal government.
3. Protection for passengers in the event of significant itinerary changes not due to nature (ie a hurricane) needs to be included. Significant should be designated as affecting more than a percentage of cruise days, or based on a table of X days in a 1-4 day cruise, Y days in a 5-8 day cruise, etc.

Thank you for your consideration of my comments
Katherine Bisig-Moore

